P3↔P2 Inheritance Subseries Overview: Eight Paper 2 Commitments Extended to Inter-Self Scope

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Attribution

This work derives from and formalizes commitments across the CKS theory trilogy: *The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model* (Li, April 2026), *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems* (Li, April 2026), and *Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration* (Li, April 2026). It does not introduce new architectural commitments. Its contribution is to identify the eight Paper 2 commitments that Paper 3 extends to inter-Self scope, state their Paper 3 extensions in compact form, and establish the structure of the eleven CC.09–CC.19 notes that formalize each extension in turn.

Abstract

Series CC formalizes the inheritance edges between Paper 3 and the prior two papers in the CKS trilogy. Notes CC.00–CC.07 addressed the P3↔P1 relationship, culminating in the synthesis claim that Paper 3 is Paper 1 at inter-Self scope. This note, CC.08, opens the second subseries and addresses the P3↔P2 relationship. The parallel synthesis claim is that Paper 3 coordinates *between* Paper 2 architectures—it does not replace or supplement them but operates over them, with FAI as the canonical operation across two or more Paper 2-compliant Selves. The note identifies eight Paper 2 architectural commitments that Paper 3 extends to inter-Self scope: the instinct/reasoning separation, three evolution mechanisms, lifecycle governance, structural hierarchy, mating as governed primitive, vertical evolution, structural co-adaptation, and directed selection. For each, the note names the Paper 2 source and the Paper 3 extension in a single sentence, then maps the eleven notes that formalize the subseries.

1. Position in Series CC

CC.00 introduced the Series CC framework: a set of cross-derivation notes formalizing that Paper 3's inter-Self architecture inherits from, and extends, the architectural commitments Papers 1 and 2 independently established. CC.01–CC.07 worked through the P3↔P1 relationship, covering seven inheritance edges from Paper 1's cell-scope commitments to their Paper 3 inter-Self counterparts. CC.07 offered the synthesis: *Paper 3 is Paper 1 at inter-Self scope*—the same substrate-based, human-governed, conflict-preserving, AI-mediated design pattern, extended to coordination across a perimeter that spans two or more distinct Selves.

CC.08 opens the second subseries. The P3↔P2 relationship is structurally distinct from the P3↔P1 relationship and requires separate treatment. Paper 1 establishes the cell as the atomic coordination unit; Paper 3 inherits that unit at inter-Self scope without modification. Paper 2 establishes the *Self*—a governed, evolving architecture composed of cells through aspects—as the unit Paper 3 coordinates between. Paper 3 does not redefine the Self; it presupposes it. Every Self participating in a Full Aspect Integration (FAI) event is a Paper 2-compliant Self, operating its intra-Self lifecycle and evolution under Paper 2's architecture. FAI is additive: it extends what Selves can do together without displacing what each Self does alone.

This structural relationship—Paper 3 built on Paper 2 architectures as its participating units—is the foundational claim the P3↔P2 subseries establishes. CC.09–CC.16 formalize eight specific inheritance edges. CC.17 covers additional inheritance edges not captured in the eight. CC.18 addresses boundary cases: where Paper 2 stops and Paper 3 begins. CC.19 offers the P3↔P2 synthesis.

2. Why the P3↔P2 Relationship Is Foundational, Not Parallel

The distinction between *foundational* and *parallel* is load-bearing for this subseries. A parallel relationship would mean two architectures that independently implement common principles at different scopes—Paper 2 doing one thing, Paper 3 doing a related but separate thing. The P3↔P2 relationship is not parallel in this sense. Paper 3 requires Paper 2-compliant Selves as its participating units. The shared substrate is constructed to mediate coordination between Selves that already have their own home substrates, governed lifecycle primitives, and intra-Self evolution machinery. FAI exchanges aspect-level content that Paper 2's three-level structure makes available. The four-locus evolution feed at FAI dissolution routes content into each participating Self's existing Paper 2 evolution mechanisms—it does not introduce new mechanisms; it routes new inputs to the mechanisms Paper 2 already specifies.

This foundational character has a precise implication for how the P3↔P2 inheritance notes should be read: each inheritance edge establishes not merely that Paper 3 resembles Paper 2 but that Paper 3 *requires* Paper 2 at the relevant commitment. A system without Paper 2's instinct/reasoning separation cannot correctly implement Paper 3's instinct non-crossing commitment, because there is nothing to bound the exchange against. A system without Paper 2's three evolution mechanisms has no home machinery for the four-locus feed to route into. The inheritance is architectural dependency, not conceptual resonance.

3. Eight Paper 2 Commitments and Their Paper 3 Extensions

Commitment 1 — Instinct/reasoning separation (B1.01). Paper 2 separates fast-pattern instinct from deliberate reasoning into independently-evolving layers within each Self, with the boundary itself as governed substrate content. Paper 3 extends this separation to the inter-Self perimeter: exchange in FAI is bounded to reasoning-layer content (DNA-layer and action-layer substrate content), while instinct-layer content and LLM weights do not cross the perimeter by architectural commitment. CC.09

formalizes this edge.

Commitment 2 — Three evolution mechanisms (B1.09–B1.12). Paper 2 commits each Self to three evolution mechanisms in productive tension—instinct evolution as undirected mutation, DNA evolution as directed selection, and action-feedback evolution as the operational-evidence loop—applying at every level of composition simultaneously. Paper 3 extends this architecture with a fourth locus at the FAI hand-off boundary: when the shared substrate dissolves, FAI-derived content routes into each participating Self's existing Paper 2 evolution mechanisms under governance-configured ingestion. CC.10 formalizes this edge.

Commitment 3 — Lifecycle governance (B1.05–B1.08). Paper 2 establishes birth, mating, and death as governed primitives operating uniformly at every level of the Self's three-level structure, each with type-specific governance processes. Paper 3 extends lifecycle governance to the shared substrate itself: the shared substrate is constructed (born) to mediate a specific FAI interaction and dissolved (retired) at the interaction's close, with persistence policy as governance-configured substrate content. CC.11 formalizes this edge.

Commitment 4 — Structural hierarchy (B1.02). Paper 2 organizes each Self across three composition levels—cells, aspects, Self—with relational role membership and the DNA/action layer distinction within every cell. Paper 3 takes the aspect as the unit of exchange in FAI, inheriting Paper 2's three-level structure as the source of the exchangeable unit and as the boundary within which content tiers operate. CC.12 formalizes this edge.

Commitment 5 — Mating as governed primitive (B1.07). Paper 2 defines mating as a single governable primitive over content combination, with three pattern variants—full merge, governance-configured partial merge, and lineage-preserved union—operating at cell, aspect, and Self scope. Paper 3 defines FAI using the same three pattern variants at inter-Self scope, with full merge as the architectural default, making FAI the inter-Self analog of Paper 2's intra-Self mating primitive. CC.13 formalizes this edge.

Commitment 6 — Vertical evolution (C1.21). Paper 2's horizontal and vertical evolution axes allow insights and improvements generated at lower composition levels to propagate upward through tiers under governance. Paper 3 extends vertical propagation to the inter-Self boundary: FAI events can originate vertical propagation within a participating Self when absorbed DNA-layer content triggers refinement that moves upward through that Self's aspect and Self-level governance. CC.14 formalizes this edge.

Commitment 7 — Structural co-adaptation (C1.30). Paper 2 commits each Self's architecture to adapt structurally in response to operational needs, with structural changes themselves as governed content. Paper 3 extends co-adaptation to the inter-Self context: repeated FAI events can produce governance-authorized structural changes within participating Selves—new aspects, modified DNA configurations—as each Self's architecture adapts to the coordination patterns its inter-Self engagement reveals. CC.15 formalizes this edge.

Commitment 8 — Directed selection and proposing substrate (B1.14, B1.15). Paper 2 establishes directed selection as one of its three evolution mechanisms, operating over the CKS substrate's stabilized orchestration content under governance-defined goals, with proposal-and-acceptance machinery for action-feedback substrate-change cycles. Paper 3 extends directed selection to inter-Self scope through DNA absorption governance: when a Self's home governance decides which FAI-derived DNA-layer content to absorb, it is exercising directed selection at inter-Self scope, applying explicit criteria over externally-sourced substrate content under the same authority architecture Paper 2 specifies for intra-Self DNA evolution. CC.16 formalizes this edge.

4. Structure of CC.09–CC.19

The eleven notes composing the P3↔P2 subseries are distributed as follows.

CC.09–CC.16 each formalize one of the eight edges above. Each note states the Paper 2 commitment at its source, states the Paper 3 extension at its target scope, identifies the exact mechanism of inheritance (requirement, analog, or extension), and notes the precise boundary: where Paper 2 stops and where Paper 3 picks up.

CC.17 covers P3↔P2 inheritance edges not captured in the eight primary commitments. Expected territory includes home perimeter governance—Paper 2's Self home perimeter as the governance boundary Paper 3's shared substrate spans—and governance substrate structure: the multi-shaped governance forms Paper 2 co-determines with its three evolution mechanisms, which Paper 3 inherits at the home perimeter and extends at the joint-authority level for inter-Self configuration.

CC.18 addresses boundary cases: situations where the P3↔P2 boundary produces ambiguity about which paper's commitments apply. The primary boundary cases are the lifecycle boundary (when does the shared substrate's lifecycle interact with each participating Self's lifecycle under Paper 2?), the evolution feed boundary (where does Paper 2's intra-Self DNA evolution end and Paper 3's absorption governance begin?), and the governance boundary (what does joint authority across participating Selves add to Paper 2's home perimeter governance, and what does it not replace?).

CC.19 synthesizes the P3↔P2 subseries in a single compound claim: *Paper 3 coordinates between Paper 2 architectures*—it presupposes Paper 2-compliant Selves as participating units, inherits their intra-Self architecture without replacement, and extends their lifecycle, evolution, and structural commitments to the inter-Self scope through the shared substrate and FAI.

5. The Two Synthesis Claims Together

With CC.08, the position of Paper 3 in the trilogy becomes visible across both inheritance axes simultaneously.

CC.07 established the P3↔P1 synthesis: Paper 3 is Paper 1 at inter-Self scope. Every Paper 1 commitment holds within the shared substrate—substrate-as-coordination-artifact, human-governed, conflict-preserving, AI-as-substrate-mediator, tool-agnostic, linear-cost—with the perimeter spanning multiple Selves' home boundaries rather than the boundary of a single cell.

CC.19 will establish the P3↔P2 synthesis: Paper 3 coordinates between Paper 2 architectures. The shared substrate is not merely a Paper 1 substrate at inter-Self scope; it is the coordination medium through which Paper 2-compliant Selves interact, exchange aspect-level content, and return home with governed evolution inputs ready for absorption into intra-Self machinery that was already in place.

Neither synthesis claim is sufficient alone. Reading Paper 3 only through the P3↔P1 lens produces a picture of a substrate-mediated inter-Self coordination architecture that treats its participating units as generic entities. Reading Paper 3 only through the P3↔P2 lens produces a picture of an inter-Self coordination layer for Paper 2 Selves that leaves the foundational substrate-cell commitments implicit. The two lenses together produce the complete picture the trilogy specifies: Paper 3 is what you get when you apply Paper 1's substrate-mediated, human-governed coordination design pattern to the interaction of two or more entities that are each internally organized as Paper 2 Selves.

End of CC.08 — P3↔P2 Inheritance Subseries Overview.